

Study about people in the South Africa writing research software

The purpose of this survey is to collect information about people who develop software that is used in research. We call these people [Research Software Engineers \(RSEs\)](#), but they use many different job titles (including postdoctoral researcher and research assistant).

Why did I receive this invitation?

You have received this link because you are a member of the UK RSE Association or you were identified as someone working in an RSE role. The [North-West University](#) eResearch Initiative have informally been collaborating with the [Software Sustainability Institute](#) (SSI) and various RSE leaders in the UK since 2015. The community of RSEs and specifically the SSI have loads of [resources for research software developers](#) and we hope that by running this survey, we would be able to create a broader awareness of the communities and resources that exist and help to establish a local RSE community. There is currently little reliable information about the global RSE community, so the SSI have been asked to collect this information to help funders and other research organisations develop policies that will support RSEs. This questionnaire gives you the opportunity to express your views about your current job and give us information about your career path.

Please note that this research is not compulsory and even if you decide to participate you can withdraw at any moment.

How long will it take?

There is a maximum of 64 questions in this survey. It takes about 10 to 15 minutes to complete.

Who is responsible for this survey?

This study is conducted by the University of Southampton on behalf of the [Software Sustainability Institute](#) and complies with University of Southampton ethics guidelines (reference no.: ERGO/FPSE/31060). The investigators are [Simon Hettrick](#) and [Olivier Philippe](#). The survey is hosted on Limesurvey servers in Germany and respects the provisions of the [Data Protection Act](#). These records are anonymised and access is strictly protected and granted to the main researchers only. The results of the survey will be released publicly but only after they have been processed to ensure that individual respondents can not be identified. The results will be released under a [Creative Commons by attribution, non-commercial licence](#).

If you would like more information about the research or about the data collection, please contact [Olivier Philippe](#).

If you would like to know more about RSEs in South Africa or would like to help establish a local community, please contact [Anelda van der Walt](#) or sign up for the (South) [African Carpentries Google](#)

[Group](#) for joint information about [Software/Data/Library Carpentry](#) and Research Software Engineers.

If you have a concern or would like to make a complaint, please contact [Simon Hettrick](#).

There are 66 questions in this survey.

Questions about you

1 In which country do you work? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Afghanistan
- ☐ Åland Islands
- ☐ Albania
- ☐ Algeria
- ☐ American Samoa
- ☐ Andorra
- ☐ Angola
- ☐ Anguilla
- ☐ Antarctica
- ☐ Antigua and Barbuda
- ☐ Argentina
- ☐ Armenia
- ☐ Aruba
- ☐ Australia
- ☐ Austria
- ☐ Azerbaijan
- ☐ Bahamas
- ☐ Bahrain
- ☐ Bangladesh
- ☐ Barbados
- ☐ Belarus
- ☐ Belgium
- ☐ Belize
- ☐ Benin
- ☐ Bermuda
- ☐ Bhutan
- ☐ Bolivia, Plurinational State of
- ☐ Bonaire, Sint Eustatius and Saba

- ☐ Bosnia and Herzegovina
- ☐ Botswana
- ☐ Bouvet Island
- ☐ Brazil
- ☐ British Indian Ocean Territory
- ☐ Brunei Darussalam
- ☐ Bulgaria
- ☐ Burkina Faso
- ☐ Burundi
- ☐ Cambodia
- ☐ Cameroon
- ☐ Canada
- ☐ Cape Verde
- ☐ Cayman Islands
- ☐ Central African Republic
- ☐ Chad
- ☐ Chile
- ☐ China
- ☐ Christmas Island
- ☐ Cocos (Keeling) Islands
- ☐ Colombia
- ☐ Comoros
- ☐ Congo
- ☐ Congo, the Democratic Republic of the
- ☐ Cook Islands
- ☐ Costa Rica
- ☐ Côte d'Ivoire
- ☐ Croatia
- ☐ Cuba
- ☐ Curaçao
- ☐ Cyprus
- ☐ Czech Republic

- ☐ Denmark
- ☐ Djibouti
- ☐ Dominica
- ☐ Dominican Republic
- ☐ Ecuador
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ El Salvador
- ☐ Equatorial Guinea
- ☐ Eritrea
- ☐ Estonia
- ☐ Ethiopia
- ☐ Falkland Islands (Malvinas)
- ☐ Faroe Islands
- ☐ Fiji
- ☐ Finland
- ☐ France
- ☐ French Guiana
- ☐ French Polynesia
- ☐ French Southern Territories
- ☐ Gabon
- ☐ Gambia
- ☐ Georgia
- ☐ Germany
- ☐ Ghana
- ☐ Gibraltar
- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Greenland
- ☐ Grenada
- ☐ Guadeloupe
- ☐ Guam
- ☐ Guatemala
- ☐ Guernsey

- ☐ Guinea
- ☐ Guinea-Bissau
- ☐ Guyana
- ☐ Haiti
- ☐ Heard Island and McDonald Islands
- ☐ Holy See (Vatican City State)
- ☐ Honduras
- ☐ Hong Kong
- ☐ Hungary
- ☐ Iceland
- ☐ India
- ☐ Indonesia
- ☐ Iran, Islamic Republic of
- ☐ Iraq
- ☐ Ireland
- ☐ Isle of Man
- ☐ Israel
- ☐ Italy
- ☐ Jamaica
- ☐ Japan
- ☐ Jersey
- ☐ Jordan
- ☐ Kazakhstan
- ☐ Kenya
- ☐ Kiribati
- ☐ Korea, Democratic People's Republic of
- ☐ Korea, Republic of
- ☐ Kuwait
- ☐ Kyrgyzstan
- ☐ Lao People's Democratic Republic
- ☐ Latvia
- ☐ Lebanon

- ☐ Lesotho
- ☐ Liberia
- ☐ Libya
- ☐ Liechtenstein
- ☐ Lithuania
- ☐ Luxembourg
- ☐ Macao
- ☐ Macedonia, the Former Yugoslav Republic of
- ☐ Madagascar
- ☐ Malawi
- ☐ Malaysia
- ☐ Maldives
- ☐ Mali
- ☐ Malta
- ☐ Marshall Islands
- ☐ Martinique
- ☐ Mauritania
- ☐ Mauritius
- ☐ Mayotte
- ☐ Mexico
- ☐ Micronesia, Federated States of
- ☐ Moldova, Republic of
- ☐ Monaco
- ☐ Mongolia
- ☐ Montenegro
- ☐ Montserrat
- ☐ Morocco
- ☐ Mozambique
- ☐ Myanmar
- ☐ Namibia
- ☐ Nauru
- ☐ Nepal

- ☐ Netherlands
- ☐ New Caledonia
- ☐ New Zealand
- ☐ Nicaragua
- ☐ Niger
- ☐ Nigeria
- ☐ Niue
- ☐ Norfolk Island
- ☐ Northern Mariana Islands
- ☐ Norway
- ☐ Oman
- ☐ Pakistan
- ☐ Palau
- ☐ Palestine, State of
- ☐ Panama
- ☐ Papua New Guinea
- ☐ Paraguay
- ☐ Peru
- ☐ Philippines
- ☐ Pitcairn
- ☐ Poland
- ☐ Portugal
- ☐ Puerto Rico
- ☐ Qatar
- ☐ Réunion
- ☐ Romania
- ☐ Russian Federation
- ☐ Rwanda
- ☐ Saint Barthélemy
- ☐ Saint Helena, Ascension and Tristan da Cunha
- ☐ Saint Kitts and Nevis
- ☐ Saint Lucia

- ☐ Saint Martin (French part)
- ☐ Saint Pierre and Miquelon
- ☐ Saint Vincent and the Grenadines
- ☐ Samoa
- ☐ San Marino
- ☐ Sao Tome and Principe
- ☐ Saudi Arabia
- ☐ Senegal
- ☐ Serbia
- ☐ Seychelles
- ☐ Sierra Leone
- ☐ Singapore
- ☐ Sint Maarten (Dutch part)
- ☐ Slovakia
- ☐ Slovenia
- ☐ Solomon Islands
- ☐ Somalia
- ☐ South Africa
- ☐ South Georgia and the South Sandwich Islands
- ☐ South Sudan
- ☐ Spain
- ☐ Sri Lanka
- ☐ Sudan
- ☐ Suriname
- ☐ Svalbard and Jan Mayen
- ☐ Swaziland
- ☐ Sweden
- ☐ Switzerland
- ☐ Syrian Arab Republic
- ☐ Taiwan, Province of China
- ☐ Tajikistan
- ☐ Tanzania, United Republic of

- ☐ Thailand
- ☐ Timor-Leste
- ☐ Togo
- ☐ Tokelau
- ☐ Tonga
- ☐ Trinidad and Tobago
- ☐ Tunisia
- ☐ Turkey
- ☐ Turkmenistan
- ☐ Turks and Caicos Islands
- ☐ Tuvalu
- ☐ Uganda
- ☐ Ukraine
- ☐ United Arab Emirates
- ☐ United Kingdom
- ☐ United States
- ☐ United States Minor Outlying Islands
- ☐ Uruguay
- ☐ Uzbekistan
- ☐ Vanuatu
- ☐ Venezuela, Bolivarian Republic of
- ☐ Viet Nam
- ☐ Virgin Islands, British
- ☐ Virgin Islands, U.S.
- ☐ Wallis and Futuna
- ☐ Western Sahara
- ☐ Yemen
- ☐ Zambia
- ☐ Zimbabwe

2 What is the highest qualification you have obtained? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Grade 12 (National Senior Certificate) or National (vocational) Cert. level 4
- ☐ Further Education (National Diploma, Advanced certificates, Higher Certificates, Advanced National (vocational) Certificate, ...)
- ☐ Undergraduate degree
- ☐ Honours degree
- ☐ Master degree
- ☐ Doctorate
- ☐ None

3 In which subject is your highest academic qualification? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Accounting & Finance
- ☐ Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering
- ☐ African languages
- ☐ Agriculture & Forestry
- ☐ American Studies
- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology
- ☐ Anthropology
- ☐ Architecture
- ☐ Art & Design
- ☐ Biological Sciences
- ☐ Business & Management Studies
- ☐ Chemical Engineering
- ☐ Chemistry
- ☐ Civil Engineering
- ☐ Classics & Ancient History
- ☐ Communication & Media Studies
- ☐ Complementary Medicine
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Counselling
- ☐ Criminology
- ☐ Dentistry
- ☐ East & South Asian Studies
- ☐ Economics
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Electrical & Electronic Engineering
- ☐ English
- ☐ Fashion
- ☐ Food Science

- ☐ French
- ☐ Geography & Environmental Sciences
- ☐ Geology
- ☐ General Engineering
- ☐ German
- ☐ History
- ☐ History of Art, Architecture & Design
- ☐ Hospitality, Leisure, Recreation & Tourism
- ☐ Iberian Languages/Hispanic Studies
- ☐ Land & Property Management
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Librarianship & Information Management
- ☐ Linguistics
- ☐ Marketing
- ☐ Materials Technology
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Mechanical Engineering
- ☐ Medicine
- ☐ Middle Eastern and African Studies
- ☐ Music
- ☐ Nursing
- ☐ Ophthalmics
- ☐ Pharmacology & Pharmacy
- ☐ Philosophy
- ☐ Physics and Astronomy
- ☐ Physiotherapy
- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Psychology
- ☐ Robotics
- ☐ Russian & East European Languages
- ☐ Social Policy
- ☐ Social Work

- ☐ Sociology
- ☐ Sports Science
- ☐ Theology & Religious Studies
- ☐ Town & Country Planning and Landscape Design
- ☐ Veterinary Medicine
- ☐ Youth Work

4 Do you hold any other professional degrees/qualifications? (Please enter each of them separated by a semicolon)

Please write your answer here:

5 Do you write code as part of your job? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

6 Who uses the code that you write? *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

- | 0 -
Mostly
me | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 -
Mostly
other
people |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

7 Do you consider yourself a professional software developer? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

8 How many years of Software development experience do you have? *

Please write your answer here:

9 *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
	(Never)									(Always)
In an average month, how much time do you spend on software development (Please rate your answer between 1 to 10. 1 Being none at all and 10 being All your time.)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time do you spend on Research	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time do you spend on Management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time do you spend on Teaching	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time do you spend on Other activities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time would you like to spend on programming? (Please rate your answer between 1 to 10. 1 Being none at all and 10 being All your time.)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	1 (Never)	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10 (Always)
In an average month, how much time would you like to spend on Research	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time would you like to spend on Management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In an average month, how much time would you like to spend on Teaching	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Your current employment

10 What type of organisation do you work for? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ University
- ☐ Research Council
- ☐ Research Organisation (e.g. SKA, HartRAO, SAEON, SANSA, ...)
- ☐ Private Company
- ☐ Start-up Company
- ☐ Non-profit Organisation
- ☐ Government

11 Which University? Please please provide the full official name of the university or organisation e.g. University of Cape Town if your organisation is not listed *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Cape Peninsula University of Technology
- ☐ Central University of Technology
- ☐ Durban University of Technology
- ☐ Mangosuthu University of Technology
- ☐ Nelson Mandela University
- ☐ North-West University
- ☐ Rhodes University
- ☐ Sefako Makgatho Health Sciences University
- ☐ Sol Plaatje University
- ☐ Tshwane University of Technology
- ☐ University of Cape Town
- ☐ University of Fort Hare
- ☐ University of Johannesburg
- ☐ University of KwaZulu-Natal
- ☐ University of Limpopo
- ☐ University of Mpumalanga
- ☐ University of Pretoria
- ☐ University of South Africa
- ☐ University of Stellenbosch
- ☐ University of the Free State
- ☐ University of the Western Cape
- ☐ University of the Witwatersrand
- ☐ University of Venda
- ☐ University of Zululand
- ☐ Vaal University of Technology
- ☐ Walter Sisulu University
- ☐ Other

12 Which organisation do you work for? *

Please write your answer here:

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

13 What is your official job title? *

Please write your answer here:

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

14 Are you known by a different job title? If so, please enter the job title you use *

Please write your answer here:

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

15 Do you work full time or part time *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Full Time

☐ Part-time

16 What type of contract are you employed on? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Permanent -- funded by University core funding
- ☐ Permanent -- as long as funding is available
- ☐ Fixed term
- ☐ Freelance consultant/contractor

17 What is the total duration of your current employment (in years)? *

Please write your answer here:

18 In which disciplines do you work (select as many as apply) *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Accounting & Finance
- ☐ Aeronautical & Manufacturing Engineering
- ☐ African languages
- ☐ Agriculture & Forestry
- ☐ American Studies
- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology
- ☐ Anthropology
- ☐ Architecture
- ☐ Art & Design
- ☐ Biological Sciences
- ☐ Business & Management Studies
- ☐ Chemical Engineering
- ☐ Chemistry
- ☐ Civil Engineering
- ☐ Classics & Ancient History
- ☐ Communication & Media Studies
- ☐ Complementary Medicine
- ☐ Computer Science
- ☐ Counselling
- ☐ Criminology
- ☐ Dentistry
- ☐ East & South Asian Studies
- ☐ Economics
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Electrical & Electronic Engineering
- ☐ English
- ☐ Fashion
- ☐ Food Science
- ☐ French
- ☐ Geography & Environmental Sciences
- ☐ Geology

- ☐ General Engineering
- ☐ German
- ☐ History
- ☐ History of Art, Architecture & Design
- ☐ Hospitality, Leisure, Recreation & Tourism
- ☐ Iberian Languages/Hispanic Studies
- ☐ Land & Property Management
- ☐ Law
- ☐ Librarianship & Information Management
- ☐ Linguistics
- ☐ Marketing
- ☐ Materials Technology
- ☐ Mathematics
- ☐ Mechanical Engineering
- ☐ Medicine
- ☐ Middle Eastern and African Studies
- ☐ Music
- ☐ Nursing
- ☐ Ophthalmics
- ☐ Pharmacology & Pharmacy
- ☐ Philosophy
- ☐ Physics and Astronomy
- ☐ Physiotherapy
- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Psychology
- ☐ Robotics
- ☐ Russian & East European Languages
- ☐ Social Policy
- ☐ Social Work
- ☐ Sociology
- ☐ Sports Science
- ☐ Theology & Religious Studies
- ☐ Town & Country Planning and Landscape Design
- ☐ Veterinary Medicine
- ☐ Youth Work

Your employment history

19 Where was your previous job based? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ This is my first job
- ☐ University
- ☐ Research Council
- ☐ Research Organisation (e.g. SKA, HartRAO, SAEON, SANSA, ...)
- ☐ Private Company
- ☐ Start-up Company
- ☐ Non-profit Organisation
- ☐ Government

20 Rank the following factors dependent on how strongly they influenced your decision to accept your current position *

Please number each box in order of preference from 1 to 9

Freedom to choose own working practices

Desire to advance research

The salary

Opportunity to develop software

Flexible working hours

Desire to work in a research environment

Opportunity for career advancement

Ability to work across disciplines

I want to learn new skills

Your working practices

21 Do you always work with the same researcher(s), or do you regularly change the researcher(s) you work with? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐

Same researcher(s)

☐

Regularly change researcher(s)

22 Do you work for a Research Software Group? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

23 Has your software contributed to research that has been published in a journal or at a conference? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

24 In general, when your software contributes to a paper, are you acknowledged in that paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

25 Are you generally named as the main author of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

26 Are you generally named as a co-author of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

27 Are you generally acknowledged in the main text of the paper? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

28 Have you ever presented your software work at a conference or workshop? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

29 Which conference(s)/workshop(s) (Please write a comma separated list with FULLNAME and ACRONYM) *

Please write your answer here:

30 How many software projects are you currently involved in? *

Please write your answer here:

31 How many programmers are in your team - 1 means you are the only person? *

Please write your answer here:

32 If you have more than 1 fellow programmer in your team, where are they from? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Same institution
- ☐ Other organisation
- ☐ Not applicable

33 Which, if any, version control tools do you use for software development? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ CVS
- ☐ SVN
- ☐ GIT
- ☐ Mercurial
- ☐ None

34 Which, if any, online collaboration tools and open repositories do you use for software development? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Github
- ☐ Bitbucket
- ☐ Zenodo
- ☐ Figshare
- ☐ Institutional Repository
- ☐ None

35 What is the bus factor of your most important software project? (the bus factor is the number of team members who, if run over by a bus, would put the project in jeopardy, so 1 means the project is dependent on a single person) *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

- | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5+ |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

36 Is there a technical hand-over plan for your most important software project? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

37 In general, what sort of testing do you conduct on your software? (check all that apply) *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ No formal testing
- ☐ Developers conduct testing
- ☐ Test engineers conduct testing
- ☐ Users conduct testing

38 Have you ever released your software under an open-source licence? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

39 How often do you release the software projects you've worked on under an open-source licence? *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

1										10
(Never)	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	(Always)	
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

40 Which open source licences do you prefer to use for your software? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Apache License 2.0
- ☐ BSD 3-Clause "New" or "Revised" license
- ☐ BSD 2-Clause "Simplified" or "FreeBSD" license
- ☐ Common Development and Distribution License
- ☐ Eclipse Public License
- ☐ GNU General Public License (GPL)
- ☐ GNU Library or "Lesser" General Public License (LGPL)
- ☐ MIT license
- ☐ Mozilla Public License 2.0
- ☐ I don't know

41 Have you ever used a Digital Object Identifier (DOI) to identify your software? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

42 How often do you associate your software with a Digital Object Identifier (DOI)? *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

- | 1 | | | | | | | | | 10 |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| (Never) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | (Always) |
| ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

43 What are your three (3) favourite tools to manage project deliverables, keep track of progress, communicate with your project group(s)? (Please write a comma separated list, eg: Slack, Trello, Google Wave) *

Please write your answer here:

44 Have you ever trained researchers in computational techniques? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

45 On average, how many times a year do you take part in providing training? *

Please write your answer here:

46 What training programs are you involved with (comma separated list) (For example, Software Carpentry, local university training, etc.) *

Please write your answer here:

47 Do you know the source of the funding used to support you and your current, largest project? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

☐ Yes

☐ No

48 Which of the following sources are used to pay for your effort as an RSE/ equivalent? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

☐ I volunteer my time

☐ Donation button

☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)

☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)

☐ Books & merchandise

☐ Advertising & sponsorships

☐ Industry support

☐ Consulting & services

☐ Grants

☐ SaaS

☐ Membership

☐ Dual license

☐ Open core

☐ Foundations & consortiums

☐ Venture capital

☐ Trademark licensing & franchising

☐ Not applicable

49 Which of the following sources are used to fund your current, largest project? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ I volunteer my time
- ☐ Donation button
- ☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)
- ☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)
- ☐ Books & merchandise
- ☐ Advertising & sponsorships
- ☐ Industry support
- ☐ Consulting & services
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ SaaS
- ☐ Membership
- ☐ Dual license
- ☐ Open core
- ☐ Foundations & consortiums
- ☐ Venture capital
- ☐ Trademark licensing & franchising
- ☐ Not applicable

50 Which of the following sources were used to fund your current, largest project three years ago? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ I volunteer my time
- ☐ Donation button
- ☐ Crowdfunding (one-time)
- ☐ Crowdfunding (recurring)
- ☐ Books & merchandise
- ☐ Advertising & sponsorships
- ☐ Industry support
- ☐ Consulting & services
- ☐ Grants
- ☐ SaaS
- ☐ Membership
- ☐ Dual license
- ☐ Open core
- ☐ Foundations & consortiums
- ☐ Venture capital
- ☐ Trademark licensing & franchising
- ☐ Not applicable

Your perception of your current position

51 *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Never	Sometimes	Often	Very Often	Always
Do you receive sufficient information on the results of your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Does your work give you the opportunity to check on how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In your work, do you have access to sufficient data and information?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do you receive sufficient information on the purpose of your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Does your work provide you with direct feedback on how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Does your supervisor/ line manager inform you about how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Do your colleagues inform you about how well you are doing your work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you feel frustrated when not given the opportunity to achieve your personal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Never	Sometimes	Often	Very Often	Always
work-related goals?					
How often do you look forward to another day at work?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do you consider leaving your job?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often do dream about getting another job that will better suit your needs?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

52 *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
My current job satisfies my personal needs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel fairly well satisfied with my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I find real enjoyment in my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is likely that I will gain a promotion within my current group	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The process I have to complete to gain a promotion is clear and understandable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
There are many opportunities within my chosen career plan	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
It is likely that my next position will be an RSE role	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Given my qualifications and experience, getting a new job would not be very hard at all	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My current position is an integral part of my career plan	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
I am satisfied with the compliments from my supervisor/line manager concerning my work	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My experience is in demand on the labour market	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with my supervisor/line manager's confidence in me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can think of a number of organisations that would probably offer me a job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I like my job better than the average person	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with the recognition I receive from my supervisor/line manager for doing my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with the encouragement from my supervisor/line manager while doing my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would accept another job at the same compensation level if I was offered it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most days I am enthusiastic about my job	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree or disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree
It would not be very difficult for me to get an equivalent job in a different organisation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am satisfied with a word of thanks from my supervisor/line manager	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

53 *

Please choose the appropriate response for each item:

	0 - Not at all satisfied	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10 - Completely satisfied
In general, how satisfied are you with your current position	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
In general, how satisfied are you with your career	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Demographic questions

54 Please select your gender *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Female
- ☐ Male
- ☐ Prefer not to say

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

55 Please select your age *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ 18 to 24 years
- ☐ 25 to 34 years
- ☐ 35 to 44 years
- ☐ 45 to 54 years
- ☐ 55 to 64 years
- ☐ Age 65 or older
- ☐ Prefer not to say

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

56 How would you describe your ethnic origin? This refers to people who share the same cultural background and identity, not country of birth or nationality.

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Black
- ☐ Coloured
- ☐ Indian
- ☐ White
- ☐ Do not wish to declare

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

57 Do you have a condition that is defined as a disability by the White Paper on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2015)

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

58 Please select the range of your annual salary *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Less than R 189 880
- ☐ Between R 189 881 and R 296 540
- ☐ Between R 296 541 and R 410 460
- ☐ Between R 410 461 and R 555 600
- ☐ Between R 555 601 and R 708 310
- ☐ Between R 708 311 and R 1 500 000
- ☐ More than R 1 500 000
- ☐ Prefer not to say

IMPORTANT: This information will not be made publicly available

Final questions about you

59 What Operating System do you prefer to use at work? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ GNU/Linux
- ☐ OS X
- ☐ Windows

60 What programming languages do you use at work? (Select as many as apply) *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Swift
- ☐ JavaScript
- ☐ R
- ☐ PHP
- ☐ C
- ☐ Common Lisp
- ☐ Erlang
- ☐ Smalltalk
- ☐ CoffeeScript
- ☐ F#
- ☐ Java
- ☐ Rust
- ☐ SQL
- ☐ TypeScript
- ☐ Hack
- ☐ C++
- ☐ Visual Basic
- ☐ C#
- ☐ Matlab
- ☐ Perl
- ☐ Fortran
- ☐ Groovy
- ☐ Haskell
- ☐ Julia
- ☐ Lua
- ☐ Scala
- ☐ Objective-C
- ☐ Python
- ☐ Go
- ☐ Assembly
- ☐ VBA

- ☐ Elixir
- ☐ VB.NET
- ☐ Ruby
- ☐ Clojure
- ☐ Dart

61 Are you a member of the UK RSE Association? (Members are people who have signed up to the UK RSE mailing list) *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

62 Would you be interested in joining such an organisation if one was formed in South Africa? *

Please choose **only one** of the following:

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

63 What would you hope to get out of such an organisation (check all that apply)? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ Networking
- ☐ Software collaborations
- ☐ Research collaborations
- ☐ Training
- ☐ Research software standards and interoperability definition
- ☐ Job opportunities

64 How do you meet other RSEs? *

Please choose **all** that apply:

- ☐ UK RSE Association
- ☐ N/A

65 What three skills would you like to acquire or improve to help your work as a Research Software Engineer? The skills can be technical and non-technical. *

Please write your answer here:

66 How did you learn the skills you need to become an RSE?

Please write your answer here:

Thank you for your participation. If you are interested in the outcomes of this survey, please keep an eye on the [Software Sustainability Institute's website](#). You can also get updates by joining the [UK RSEAssociation](#).

17-01-2018 – 11:01

Submit your survey.

Thank you for completing this survey.